

The Fahrenheit version has 45 dots with increments of 0.2°F and a range of 96-104.8°F. Disposable thermometers are usually for oral temperatures. You also use them at auxiliary with a placement time of minutes. Chemical dot thermometers are useful for screening temperatures, especially in infants and young children and patients who are incubated.

Purpose of Taking Temperature

1) To aid in diagnosis or the patient's condition
2) To find out the progress of the patient.

5.5.4 Taking Temperature By Mouth

General Instructions

1) Oral temperature should not be taken immediately after the patient has had a hot or a cold drink or food.
2) Oral temperature should not be taken for the following patients.
    1. Children below the age of five years
    2. Patients receiving oxygen
    3. Patients with nasal obstruction, dyspnoea or sore throat
    4. Patient who are delirious, unconscious and not cooperating, hysterical
    5. Restless or mentally ill
    6. Patients with oral surgeries.

Recording temperature – oral Equipment

Tray Containing

1) 3 or 4 test tubes or bottles with antiseptic lotions (Savlon 2%) and a little cotton underneath
2) A glass tumbler with clean water and little cotton underneath
3) A bowl containing a bit soapy white wipers
4) A small piece of clean cloth
5) A Kidney tray
6) A Paper bag
7) Watch with second hand
8) Red lead pen

Procedure

1) Explain the procedure and take the patients cooperation
2) Let the patient be sitting or lying down
3) Remove thermometer from the lotion, wash with clean water and dry with clean piece of cloth form the bulb upwards to prevent bacteria from setting down on the lower part which goes into the mouth of the patient.
4) Shake down the mercury by 95°F. Place the bulb of the thermometer under the tongue and tell the patient not to bite the thermometer but to hold it with his lips.
5) Leave the thermometer in the mouth for 2 minutes (during this time take his pulse and respiration)
6) Remove the thermometer, note the temperature clean with the soapy

Nursing-Gen_Chapter 05.indd 68 07/05/18 12:48 PM